

Contact

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Simon Rune Stender

Systems & Game Designer

Skills

Systems Design

Gameplay Systems & Feature Ownership
Progression & Character Systems
Game Balancing & Systems Mathematics
Player Behavior & Data-Informed Iteration

Narrative & Content

Systemic Storytelling & Player-Driven Experiences
Narrative Structuring & Pacing (TTRPG Design)
Writing of Stories · Campaigns & Worldbuilding

Tools & Technical

Gameplay Scripting in Unity / Godot – personal game projects
Figma · Confluence · Jira · ClickUp
Git / version-control workflows
Able to read and debug code and collaborate directly with programmers

Languages

German (native)
English (fluent)

Profile

Game & Systems Designer with 6 years of professional experience designing, balancing and owning gameplay systems from concept to release.
Experienced in progression, pacing, live balancing and data-informed iteration, with a strong technical understanding and close cross-disciplinary collaboration.
Over a decade of TTRPG design experience creating and iterating original RPG systems, mechanics and progression structures.

Recent Projects

Logistics Empire

Released in November 2025, becoming one of Xyrality’s most successful game launches.
Designed and owned core gameplay and progression systems for a logistics spin-off of Mission Chief, maintaining its core map-based gameplay loop.
Owned feature design from concept to release, including the first major update expanding gameplay to trains, ships, and airplanes.
Created and maintained design documentation, and researched new features and technologies to support project development.
Managed and improved team workflows and coordinated cross-functional collaboration between design, engineering, and stakeholders.
Balanced and iterated gameplay systems and player progression using live player behavior, feedback and performance.

Mission Chief

Designed and iterated gameplay systems and live content for Mission Chief, a real-world emergency service simulation with map-based gameplay, supporting 23 regional versions worldwide.
Structured event chains and quest-like systems to support multi-step progression, pacing, and player-driven outcomes.
Iterated on systems, balancing, and player experience in a live environment using player behavior and feedback to inform design decisions.

Education & Employment

Since ‘20 Game & Systems Designer

at Xyrality GmbH

- ‘24 Project: Logistics Empire
- ‘20 Project: Mission Chief

‘16 to ‘21 BSc Media Informatics

at Flensburg University of Applied Science

RPG Systems Design – Personal TTRPG Project

Designed and iterated an original TTRPG rule set, including character progression, abilities, resources and interconnected gameplay mechanics.
Balanced numerical systems and player options through repeated playtesting, probability analysis and player feedback.
Designed mechanics to support distinct character builds, meaningful trade-offs and emergent interactions between systems.
Maintained rules documentation and continuously revised mechanics based on observed player behavior and edge cases.